

Concord

The word 'concord' simply means agreement or harmony. It is the agreement which must exist between the subject of a sentence; whether a noun, noun phrase or pronoun and the verb. The basic rule of concord is that singular subject must be followed by a singular verb while a plural subject must be followed by a plural verb.

Applications of Concord

1. Any time [either or/neither nor] correlates two subjects, the verb to use will be determined by the subject nearest to the verb. E.g; either James or you **is** sick.
2. [many a/many an] must be followed by a singular noun in a sentence, followed also by a singular verb. E.g; many a student **does** not read anymore.
3. A plural noun which is the subject of a sentence will take a singular verb if it is referring to time, distance, money or measurement. Plural nouns relating to time include seconds, minutes, hours, days, weeks, months, years, etc. Plural nouns relating to money include Naira, Dollars, Cedis, Rands, Rupees, etc. While the plural nouns relating to measurement include grammes, kilogrammes, yards, litres, etc. E.g; Ten million Naira **is** needed for his trip.
4. Anytime **collective** is used as the subject of a sentence, it must go with a plural noun followed by a singular verb. E.g; A battalion of soldiers **has** moved to Kano.

Words Associated with Advertisement

1. Ad = is a short form of advertisement
2. Advertisement = item of publicity on media that is meant to persuade people to buy
3. Advertising agency= a company specialising in producing and placing advertisements for clients
4. Benefit = advantage of a product or service
5. Billboard = a large signboard, usually outdoors, on which a poster-style ad is displayed
6. Coupon = a part of advertisement used for ordering goods or getting a discount
7. Eye-catcher = something that especially attracts one's attention

Speaking to Persuade

Speaking to persuasion is a method of getting someone to do, believe or accept something by means of the words. It involves reasoning with the listener, using sound arguments or a compelling entreaty.

Persuasion is usually about gaining agreement and support. It is about creating a common ground where you and others can come together in purpose of thought.

In contrast, manipulation involves controlling or influencing a person or group of people through unfair or unscrupulous means.

Record Keeping

Record Keeping refers to the process of collecting, organizing, storing, and maintaining records or information for future reference. It is an essential part of personal, business, and government operations.

Types of Record Keeping

1. **Manual Record Keeping** – Records are kept using paper files, notebooks, or registers.
2. **Electronic Record Keeping** – Records are stored using computers and digital systems like databases or spreadsheets.

Importance of Record Keeping

- **Provides accurate information** for decision-making.
- **Helps track financial transactions**, such as income and expenses.
- **Ensures legal compliance** and accountability.
- **Improves efficiency** in managing resources and activities.
- **Helps in planning and budgeting.**

Examples of Records to Keep

- Financial records (receipts, invoices, bank statements)
- Academic records (report cards, admission forms)
- Employment records (contracts, salary slips)
- Medical records
- Inventory records

Intonation

Intonation is the rise and fall of the voice when speaking. It helps to express emotions, attitudes, and the meaning of sentences beyond just the words.

Types of Intonation

1. Rising Intonation:

The voice rises at the end of the sentence. Common in yes/no questions.

Example: Are you coming?

2. Falling Intonation:

The voice falls at the end of the sentence. Used in statements, commands, and wh-questions.

Examples:

I am going home.

What is your name?

3. Rising-Falling Intonation:

The voice rises and then falls. Used to show strong feelings or surprise.

Example: Really?!

4. Falling-Rising Intonation:

The voice falls and then rises. Often shows uncertainty, hesitation, or politeness.

Example: I guess so...

Importance of Intonation:

Helps listeners understand the speaker's mood.

Clarifies the speaker's intention.

Makes speech more natural and interesting.

Reading for Words in Context

Reading for words in context means understanding the meaning of unfamiliar words or phrases by examining how they are used in a sentence or passage.

Importance:

Helps improve vocabulary without using a dictionary.

Enhances reading comprehension.

Makes reading smoother and more enjoyable.

How to Understand Words in Context:

1. Look at the surrounding words:

The words before and after can give hints about the meaning.

2. Identify context clues:

Definition Clues: The word's meaning is explained in the sentence.

Example: Photosynthesis, the process by which plants make food, requires sunlight.

Synonym Clues: A similar word is used.

Example: He was elated, or very happy, about his results.

Antonym Clues: An opposite word is used.

Example: Unlike his stingy brother, John is very generous.

Example Clues: Examples are given to explain the word.

Example: Celestial bodies, such as the sun, moon, and stars, light up the sky.

General Sense of the Passage: Use the overall idea of the sentence or paragraph.

3. Guess and Confirm:

Make an educated guess, then check if the word makes sense in that context.

Practice Tip:

While reading, underline unfamiliar words and try to figure out their meanings from context before checking the dictionary.

Oral Composition

Oral composition is the process of expressing ideas, thoughts, or stories verbally in a structured and coherent manner. It involves speaking clearly and logically, often for an audience, without necessarily writing it down first.

Types of Oral Composition

1. Narrative: Telling a story or recounting an event.
2. Descriptive: Describing a person, place, object, or event.
3. Argumentative: Expressing an opinion and supporting it with reasons and evidence.
4. Expository: Explaining a concept or process clearly and logically.
5. Dialogue/Conversation: A spoken exchange between two or more people.

Features of a Good Oral Composition

Clear structure (Introduction, Body, Conclusion)

Logical flow of ideas

Fluency and accuracy

Appropriate language and tone

Confidence and audibility

Good eye contact and body language

Tips for Effective Oral Composition

Plan your speech before speaking.

Use linking words to connect ideas (e.g., firstly, however, therefore).

Avoid fillers like “um” or “you know.”

Practice speaking in front of a mirror or peers.

Listen to good speakers and learn from them.

Types of Sentences

1. Declarative Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence that makes a statement or expresses an opinion.
- **Ends with:** A full stop (.)
- **Example:**
 - *She loves reading books.*
 - *The sky is blue.*

2. Interrogative Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence that asks a question.
- **Ends with:** A question mark (?)
- **Example:**
 - *What is your name?*
 - *Are you coming to school tomorrow?*

3. Imperative Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence that gives a command, instruction, or request.

- **Ends with:** A full stop (.) or exclamation mark (!)
- **Example:**
 - *Close the door.*
 - *Please sit down.*
 - *Stop talking!*

4. Exclamatory Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence that shows strong emotion or excitement.
- **Ends with:** An exclamation mark (!)
- **Example:**
 - *What a beautiful dress!*
 - *I can't believe it!*

Words Associated with Stock Exchange

1. Stock

- **Meaning:** A share or part of ownership in a company.

2. Shareholder

- **Meaning:** A person who owns shares (stocks) in a company.

3. Dividend

- **Meaning:** The profit a company pays to its shareholders, usually in cash or more shares.

4. Stock Exchange

- **Meaning:** A marketplace where people buy and sell stocks and shares.

5. Broker

- **Meaning:** A person or company that buys and sells stocks for others and earns a commission.

6. Bull Market

- **Meaning:** A market where prices of shares are rising and investors are confident.

7. Bear Market

- **Meaning:** A market where share prices are falling and investors are cautious or fearful.

8. Portfolio

- **Meaning:** A collection of different investments (stocks, bonds, etc.) owned by a person or company.

9. Capital Gain

- **Meaning:** The profit made when a stock is sold for more than it was bought.

10. IPO (Initial Public Offering)

- **Meaning:** The first time a company sells its shares to the public on the stock exchange.

Emphatic Stress

Emphatic Stress is the special force or emphasis placed on a word in a sentence to show importance, contrast, or strong feeling. It helps to **highlight the exact meaning** the speaker wants to convey.

Why We Use Emphatic Stress

- To **correct** wrong information
- To **show surprise or emotion**
- To **make a contrast**

Examples of Emphatic Stress

Consider this simple sentence: "**She passed the exam.**"

By stressing different words, the meaning changes:

1. "*She*** passed the exam.**"
– Emphasis: It was *she*, not someone else.
2. "**She** *passed* the exam."
– Emphasis: She *passed*, not failed.
3. "**She** **passed** *the* exam."
– Emphasis: That *specific* exam.
4. "**She** **passed** the *exam*."
– Emphasis: She passed an *exam*, not a test or assignment.

How It's Used in Speech

In spoken English, emphatic stress is applied by:

- Raising your voice slightly on the word

- Slowing down to make it clearer
- Sometimes using gestures or facial expressions

Synonyms

Word	Synonym(s)
Happy	Glad, joyful, cheerful
Big	Large, huge, massive
Small	Tiny, little, miniature
Fast	Quick, rapid, speedy
Smart	Intelligent, clever, bright
Sad	Unhappy, sorrowful, gloomy
Start	Begin, commence, launch
End	Finish, conclude, terminate
Help	Assist, aid, support
Say	Speak, tell, express
Look	See, glance, observe
Beautiful	Pretty, lovely, attractive
Strong	Powerful, sturdy, tough
Quiet	Silent, calm, peaceful
Angry	Mad, furious, annoyed

Types Of Clauses

1. Main Clause (Independent Clause)

- Can stand alone as a complete sentence.
- Expresses a complete thought.

Examples:

- She sings beautifully.
- The boy ran away.

2. Subordinate Clause (Dependent Clause)

- Cannot stand alone as a complete sentence.
- Depends on the main clause to make sense.

There are **three major types** of subordinate clauses:

a. Noun Clause

- Functions like a noun (subject, object, or complement).

Examples:

- What she said was true. (*Subject*)
- I know that he is lying. (*Object*)

b. Adjective Clause (Relative Clause)

- Describes or gives more information about a noun.
- Begins with relative pronouns like **who, whom, whose, which, that**.

Examples:

- The girl **who won the prize** is my sister.
- This is the book **that I borrowed**.

c. Adverbial Clause

- Acts like an adverb; tells **when, where, why, how**, etc.
- Begins with subordinating conjunctions like **because, although, when, if, since, after, before, while**, etc.

Examples:

- I left **because it was late**. (*Reason*)

- **When the bell rings, we will go for lunch. (Time)**

Simple/Polite Request And Simple Greetings

Simple/Polite Requests

A **request** is when we ask someone to do something for us. When we add polite words like **please** or use respectful expressions, it becomes a **polite request**.

Common Phrases for Polite Requests:

1. **Can you...? / Could you...?**
 - *Can you help me with my homework, please?*
 - *Could you pass me the salt, please?*
2. **Would you mind...?**
 - *Would you mind opening the window?*
 - *Would you mind helping me with this bag?*
3. **Would you please...?**
 - *Would you please sit down?*
 - *Would you please be quiet?*
4. **Do you mind...?**
 - *Do you mind if I use your pen?*
 - *Do you mind if I join you?*

Simple Greetings

Greetings are polite expressions used when meeting or speaking to someone.

Types of Greetings:

A. Formal Greetings (Used with elders, strangers, or in official situations)

- Good morning.
- Good afternoon.
- Good evening.
- How do you do?
- It's a pleasure to meet you.

B. Informal Greetings (Used with friends, family, or people of the same age)

- Hi!
- Hello!
- Hey!
- What's up?
- How are you?

In Summary:

- Use polite words like **please**, **could**, and **would** when making requests.
- Choose formal or informal greetings depending on the person and situation.
- Always respond to greetings with respect and friendliness.

Antonyms

Antonyms are words that have **opposite meanings**.

Examples of Antonyms:

Word Antonym

Hot Cold

Big Small

Happy Sad

Fast Slow

Open Close

Up Down

Early Late

Light Dark

Win Lose

NOUN CLAUSE

A noun clause is a group of words that acts as a noun in a sentence. It usually contains a subject and a verb, but cannot stand alone as a complete sentence.

Functions of a Noun Clause:

A noun clause can function as:

1. Subject of a sentence

- *What she said* was surprising.
(Noun clause as subject)

2. Object of a verb

- I know *that he is honest*.
(Noun clause as object)

3. Object of a preposition

- They are worried about *what might happen*.
(Noun clause as object of a preposition)

4. Complement of a sentence

- The truth is *that she lied*.
(Noun clause as complement)

Common Introducers of Noun Clauses:

Noun clauses often begin with these words: **that, what, whatever, who, whom, whoever, whomever, whether, if, why, when** and **how**

Examples:

Sentence	Function of Noun Clause
What you did was wrong.	Subject
I believe that she will come.	Object of the verb "believe"
They are interested in what he said.	Object of a preposition
The fact is that he was late.	Complement

Tip:

If a group of words answers "**what?**" or "**who?**" in the sentence and contains a verb, it's likely a **noun clause**.

Adjectival Clause

An **adjectival clause** (also called a **relative clause**) is a group of words that describes or gives more information about a noun or pronoun in the main clause. It functions like an **adjective** in a sentence.

Key Features:

- It **begins with a relative pronoun**:
 - **who** (for people)
 - **whom** (formal, for people – object position)
 - **whose** (possession)
 - **which** (for things and animals)
 - **that** (for people or things)
- It is usually **placed directly after the noun** it describes.

Examples:

1. The boy **who won the prize** is my cousin.
→ "who won the prize" describes "the boy".
2. I saw the dog **that barked all night**.
→ "that barked all night" describes "the dog".
3. The woman **whose car was stolen** is crying.
→ "whose car was stolen" describes "the woman".

4. They hired the man **whom we interviewed yesterday**.
→ "whom we interviewed yesterday" describes "the man".

Types of Adjectival Clauses:

1. **Defining (Restrictive) Clauses**
 - Give essential information.
 - **No commas** are used.
 - Example:
 - The student **who studies hard** will pass.
2. **Non-defining (Non-restrictive) Clauses**
 - Add extra information (not essential).
 - Use **commas** to separate them.
 - Example:
 - My brother, **who lives in Lagos**, is a doctor.

Omitting the Relative Pronoun:

Sometimes, the relative pronoun can be left out when it refers to the object of the clause.
Example:

- The book **that I bought** is interesting.
- The book **I bought** is interesting. ✓

Functions in the Sentence:

Adjectival clauses describe nouns and act like adjectives, answering "**Which one?**" or "**What kind?**"

Quick Exercise: Identify the adjectival clause

1. The girl **who sang at the party** is my friend.
2. I found the key **that opens the garage**.
3. The man **whom you met** is a teacher.

Argumentative Essay

An **argumentative essay** is a type of essay that presents arguments **for or against** a particular topic. The writer takes a **clear stance** on an issue and supports it with **logical reasoning, facts, examples, and evidence**.

Purpose

To **convince** or **persuade** the reader to accept a particular point of view or take a specific action.

Features of an Argumentative Essay

1. **Clear Thesis Statement** – States your position on the issue.
2. **Introduction** – Introduces the topic and gives background information.
3. **Arguments For or Against** – Based on the side you are supporting.
4. **Evidence and Examples** – To support each argument.
5. **Counterarguments** – Acknowledge the other side and refute it.

6. **Conclusion** – Summarizes the points and restates your position clearly.

Structure

1. **Introduction**
 - Hook: Catch the reader's attention.
 - Background: Brief information on the topic.
 - Thesis Statement: Your main argument or position.
2. **Body Paragraphs**
 - **Point 1:** Topic sentence, explanation, evidence/example.
 - **Point 2:** Topic sentence, explanation, evidence/example.
 - **Point 3:** Same structure.
 - (Include a **paragraph for counterargument** and refutation.)
3. **Conclusion**
 - Restate thesis.
 - Summarize main points.
 - End with a strong closing statement.

Useful Expressions

- *In my opinion...*
- *I strongly believe that...*
- *It is often argued that...*
- *On the other hand...*
- *However, it is important to note that...*
- *In conclusion...*

Sample Topics

- Should students wear school uniforms?
- Is social media beneficial or harmful?
- Should mobile phones be allowed in schools?
- Is online learning better than traditional learning?

Tips for Writing a Good Argumentative Essay

- Choose a debatable topic.
- Do proper research.
- Be clear and logical.
- Use linking words to connect ideas.
- Avoid emotional language.
- Proofread for grammar and spelling errors.

Active/Passive Tense

Definitions

- **Active Voice:** The subject **performs** the action of the verb.
Example: The teacher taught the lesson.
- **Passive Voice:** The subject **receives** the action of the verb.
Example: The lesson was taught by the teacher.

Structure

Active Voice Structure

Subject + Verb + Object

Example: *John (subject) wrote (verb) a letter (object).*

Passive Voice Structure

Object + form of “to be” + past participle + by + subject (optional)

Example: *A letter (object) was written (verb) by John (subject).*

Tense Changes in Passive Voice

Tense	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Simple Present	He writes a letter.	A letter is written by him.
Present Continuous	He is writing a letter.	A letter is being written by him.
Present Perfect	He has written a letter.	A letter has been written by him.
Simple Past	He wrote a letter.	A letter was written by him.
Past Continuous	He was writing a letter.	A letter was being written by him.
Past Perfect	He had written a letter.	A letter had been written by him.
Future (will)	He will write a letter.	A letter will be written by him.
Modal + verb	He can write a letter.	A letter can be written by him.

When to Use Passive Voice

- When the doer of the action is unknown:
Example: The window was broken.
- When the focus is on the action, not the subject:
Example: The road was repaired yesterday.
- In formal or scientific writing:
Example: The experiment was conducted in a lab.

Common Passive Voice Indicators

- Forms of the verb “to be”: is, am, are, was, were, be, been, being.
- Past participle (e.g., *eaten, written, done*).

Examples

Active	Passive
The chef cooks the food.	The food is cooked by the chef.
The police arrested the thief.	The thief was arrested by the police.

Active

Passive

She will deliver the message. The message will be delivered by her.

Tips

- Not all verbs can be used in the passive voice (intransitive verbs like *sleep, go, arrive* can't).
- Use active voice for clearer and more direct writing unless passive voice is necessary.

British And American Spellings

British and American English use different **spellings** for certain words, even though the meanings are usually the same.

Why the Difference?

- British English is the original form of the language.
- American English developed its own spellings after the U.S. became independent.
- Influenced by dictionary makers (e.g., Noah Webster in America simplified many spellings).

Common Differences

British Spelling	American Spelling	Example in a Sentence
colour	color	The sky is full of colour. / color.
favour	favor	She did me a favour. / favor.
centre	center	The town centre / center is crowded.
theatre	theater	We went to the theatre / theater.
travelling	traveling	She is travelling / traveling abroad.
cancelled	canceled	The flight was cancelled / canceled.
realise	realize	I realise / realize the mistake.
organise	organize	They organise / organize meetings.
defence	defense	The team's defence / defense was strong.
licence (noun)	license	He got his driving licence / license.

Rules and Patterns

1. **-our** (British) → **-or** (American)
e.g. colour → color, favour → favor
2. **-re** (British) → **-er** (American)
e.g. centre → center, metre → meter
3. **Double L** in verbs (British) → **Single L** (American)
e.g. travelled → traveled, cancelled → canceled
4. **-ise** (British) → **-ize** (American)
e.g. organise → organize, realise → realize
5. **-ce** vs. **-se** endings
 - **British:** licence (noun), practise (verb)
 - **American:** license (both noun and verb), practice (both)

Why is this Important?

- Exams, essays, and writing tasks may require consistency in one form.

- British English is used in Nigeria, the UK, and most Commonwealth countries.
- American English is used in the USA and is common online and in software.

Tips for Students

- Stick to **British spelling** for schoolwork in Nigeria unless told otherwise.
- Be **consistent**: don't mix both styles in one essay.
- Use dictionaries to check correct spellings (e.g., Oxford for British, Merriam-Webster for American).